

The Postpartum Freezer Prep Checklist

Thirteen sessions. Six weeks. A freezer full of meals before baby arrives.

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This is the whole plan from *Rest and Rise* on one page. Follow the sessions in order — several recipes feed into later ones, so the sequence matters. Check off each session as you finish it, then flip the page and track what lands in the freezer.

Week 30 — Setup week (no baking yet)

- ☐ Feed your starter daily for 3–4 days so it is strong and active
- ☐ Take stock of equipment: Dutch oven, loaf pans, kitchen scale, parchment, 3-inch cutter, sandwich sealer — order what's missing
- ☐ Big pantry run + bulk freezer bags, disposable trays, masking tape, permanent marker
- ☐ Optional head start: a batch (or double batch) of Instant Pot Chicken Bone Broth

Week 31 — Artisan loaves + first dinners

- ☐ **Session 1:** Mix four artisan loaf doughs; during bulk ferment, assemble the Honey Garlic Chicken and Weeknight Butter Chicken freezer bags. Doughs shaped and into the fridge overnight.
- ☐ **Session 2:** Bake all four loaves; between bakes, assemble the three Freezer Pork Shoulder bags and The House Chili.

Week 32 — English muffins + puff pastry

- ☐ **Session 3:** Mix English muffin dough and a double batch of puff pastry (both cold-ferment overnight). Afternoon: Mini Sourdough Discard Pizzas.
- ☐ **Session 4:** The big one — give it a full day. Griddle the English muffins, laminate the pastry, then make the Bacon Egg and Cheese Muffin Sandwiches, Italian Mini Quiches, and Puff Pastry Pinwheels.

Week 33 — Sweet bread, bars, broth

- ☐ **Session 5:** Cinnamon Raisin Bread (bulk ferment by day, bake in the evening) + Apricot Cranberry Granola Bars while it rises.
- ☐ **Session 6:** Start the Instant Pot Bone Broth first thing; mix and bake one Sourdough Sandwich Bread loaf for next week's meatballs. Cool it completely.

Week 34 — Meatballs + tortillas

- ☐ **Session 7:** Bake the sourdough-soaked meatballs, then build three recipes from them: Nesting Ziti (crumbled half), Aloha Meatballs bag (whole half), and the Khao Tom bag with session 6's broth.
- ☐ **Session 8:** Ferment tortilla + naan doughs in the morning; afternoon: cook tortillas, assemble Loaded Breakfast Tacos and Enchiladas That Show Up for You, cook and freeze the naan.

Week 35 — Casseroles + a treat

- ☐ **Session 9:** Two rotisserie chickens, one shredding job: Creamy Confetti Chicken Casserole + Barbecue Chicken and Sweet Potato Casserole.
- ☐ **Session 10:** Make the puff pastry reserved for session 13, then the Better Than the Box Beef and Pasta Bake, with Lactation Banana Bread in the oven while it cools.

Week 36 — The final stretch

- ☐ **Session 11:** Sandwich bread bulk-ferments all afternoon while you mix cookie dough to chill, set the Chocolate Bark, and cook the Freezer Waffles. Bake the bread in the evening; cool overnight, unsliced.
- ☐ **Session 12:** Flash-freeze cookie dough portions; bake the muffins; roll Energy Balls and Truffles; make Little Sealed Sandwiches and turn every trimmed crust into the Overnight French Toast Bake (fridge overnight).
- ☐ **Session 13:** Bake the French Toast Bake; assemble the One-Handed Breakfast Pockets with session 10's pastry. Final freezer walkthrough — you're done.

Label everything: what it is, the date, and how to reheat it — written so anyone in the house can read the note and turn on the oven. Printable labels for every recipe live at halfpintmama.com/cookbook-resources.

Freezer Inventory

Fill it in as you prep. Cross it off as you eat. Future you says thank you.

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Breads & Base Doughs

- | | |
|---|--------------------|
| ☐ Classic Artisan Sourdough Loaf | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Sourdough Sandwich Bread | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Cinnamon Raisin Bread | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Sourdough Tortillas | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Sourdough English Muffins | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Sourdough Naan | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Sourdough Puff Pastry | Qty ____ Date ____ |

Breakfast

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|---|--------------------|
| ☐ Loaded Breakfast Tacos | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Bacon Egg & Cheese Muffin Sandwiches | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ One-Handed Breakfast Pockets | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Italian Mini Quiches | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Freezer Waffles | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Overnight French Toast Bake | Qty ____ Date ____ |

Little Lunches

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|--|--------------------|
| ☐ Mini Sourdough Discard Pizzas | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Sourdough Puff Pastry Pinwheels | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Little Sealed Sandwiches | Qty ____ Date ____ |

Casseroles

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|--|--------------------|
| ☐ Nesting Ziti | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Better Than the Box Beef & Pasta Bake | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Creamy Confetti Chicken Casserole | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ BBQ Chicken & Sweet Potato Casserole | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Enchiladas That Show Up for You | Qty ____ Date ____ |

Set It and Forget It

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|--|--------------------|
| ☐ Aloha Meatballs | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ The House Chili | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Khao Tom: Thai Ginger & Rice Soup | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Instant Pot Chicken Bone Broth | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Honey Garlic Chicken | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Weeknight Butter Chicken | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Freezer Pork Shoulder: Three Ways | Qty ____ Date ____ |

Treats for Milk Making Days

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|---|--------------------|
| ☐ Lactation Chocolate Chip Cookies | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Lactation Banana Bread | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Lactation Peanut Butter Truffles | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Lactation Chocolate Bark | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Lemon Blueberry Oat Lactation Muffins | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Oat & Honey Lactation Energy Balls | Qty ____ Date ____ |
| ☐ Apricot Cranberry Lactation Granola Bars | Qty ____ Date ____ |

Freezer rule of thumb: almost everything here is best within 3 months and good up to 12. Thaw in the refrigerator, never on the counter — and crockpot meals always thaw first, while Instant Pot meals can cook straight from frozen.